

THE DIVINE INHERITANCE PROJECT

LEGISLATIVE BRIEF

State Housing Trust Administration Act (SHTAA)

Model State Legislation for Participation in the National Housing Trust System

Purpose

To ensure that every adult citizen of this State enjoys secure access to one dwelling and one commercial property — as guaranteed under the National Housing Trust Amendment — while preserving state sovereignty, private markets, and fiscal discipline.

Summary

The State Housing Trust Administration Act (SHTAA) establishes a State Housing Trust Administration (SHTA) to coordinate with the federal National Housing Trust (NHT). The SHTA manages local implementation, funding, and oversight, ensuring housing security without federal overreach. It provides transparent administration, promotes homeownership and small enterprise, and protects taxpayers through balanced-budget and audit requirements.

Key Provisions

- **State-Level Control:** Creates a State Housing Trust Administration within the executive branch, governed by a public board including municipal and citizen representatives.
- **State Housing Trust Fund:** Establishes a dedicated, nonlapsing fund to manage state revenues, progressive contributions, and federal allocations for housing security.
- **Citizen Guarantee:** Registers and assigns one primary dwelling and one commercial property per eligible adult, ensuring that property rights remain protected and non-speculative.
- **Transparency & Ethics:** Mandates quarterly public reporting, independent audits, and felony penalties for conflicts of interest or corruption.
- **Local Labor Priority:** Creates a Community Maintenance Corps to employ state residents in repair, renovation, and stewardship of housing stock.
- **Fiscal Safeguards:** Requires balanced budgets, reserve accounts, and two-thirds supermajority approval for any fiscal adjustment.
- **Interstate Cooperation:** Authorizes voluntary compacts with other states for data sharing and citizen mobility, preserving full legislative oversight.

Benefits to the State

- **Protects Property Rights** — Upholds local control and prevents speculative monopolization.
- **Stimulates Local Economies** — Expands construction, maintenance, and small-enterprise employment.
- **Reduces Public Costs** — Lowers homelessness, rental assistance, and healthcare burdens.
- **Increases Civic Stability** — Anchors citizens in communities through ownership and responsibility.
- **Strengthens Federal Partnership** — Positions the State to receive early-adopter funding and

influence federal rulemaking.

Fiscal & Legal Integrity

- Operates under balanced-budget rules and independent audits.
- Fully consistent with Article V constitutional authority and existing property law.
- No unfunded mandates; participation is voluntary and fiscally self-sustaining.

Talking Points for Sponsors

“This Act keeps the promise of liberty by securing the foundation of property for every citizen.”

“We’re ensuring housing security through local stewardship — not federal control.”

“It’s pro-market, pro-family, and pro-freedom — the modern Homestead principle reborn.”

“This isn’t redistribution — it’s constitutional restoration.”

Next Steps

1. File the SHTAA for introduction in both chambers.
2. Coordinate with the Governor’s Office and Housing Committee for fiscal review.
3. Launch bipartisan outreach emphasizing property protection, economic growth, and community independence.